

Staying safe online

Children, teens, and adults must take steps to protect their identities, personal details, and images online. While Internet filters can help, the best way to stay safe is for everyone to work together.

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◀ 134–135 Making judgments

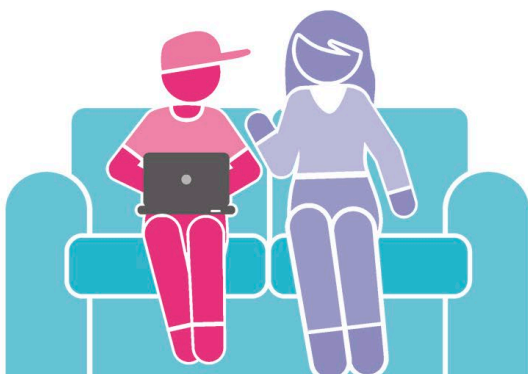
◀ 138–139 Cyberbullying

Privacy

142–143 ▶

Being prepared

Staying safe online bears many of the same rules as staying safe in the real world. Both involve knowing the potential dangers, talking them through before they occur, and having a plan of action for teens to follow if and when problems occur.



△ In it together

For teens and parents, one of the most important steps to ensuring safety online is discussing security measures together.

PARENT TIPS

Open communication

Teens need strong digital skills to empower them to make safe choices online on their own. By communicating effectively, parents can help prepare their teen to deal with any problems.

- Ask your teen questions to get them to open up about their digital activities. Try asking about favorite websites, whether someone has helped them online, and who they like to follow.
- Discuss potential dangers, and work together to research and put in place strategies to reduce the risk. The conversation should adapt as teens gain maturity.
- It's easy to become complacent, but don't stop discussing Internet safety. It's relevant at every age.
- If you feel the need to block inappropriate content using Internet filters, it's best to discuss them with your teen first rather than to use them secretly. It's also important to note that Internet filters are not completely reliable.

Taking care

Not all content is appropriate for sharing online, even if other users request it. When using the Internet, teens should take care to follow two basic rules:

Don't share personal information

Never give out personal information—such as full name, contact details, home address, school name, or bank details—to unknown entities online.



Be careful with pictures

Photographs and videos should be guarded with care. If teens are asked for images or videos of themselves, they need to say no, walk away, and tell a trusted adult.

